

"If the UPA Government at the Centre fails, it will not be because of us (the Left)."

PRAKASH KARAT, CPI(M) general secretary)

"The issue is not war. The issue is terror and territory in Pakistan is being used to provoke, aid and abet terrorism. Nobody wants war."

MANMOHAN SINGH, prime minister

"Dreams are not those you get while you are sleeping. Dreams are those that don't let you sleep."

AKHIL KUMAR, pugilist at the 2008 Beijing Olympics



MANDAR DEODHAR

"It is with my walking stick that we will unfurl the saffron flag atop Mantralaya (secretariat). This stick is needed to shoo away monkeys ruling the state."

BAL THACKERAY, Shiv Sena supremo

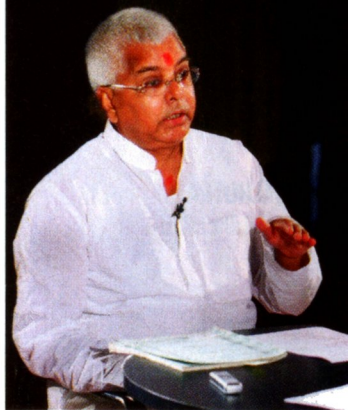
"Dr Rajesh found Aarushi and Hemraj in an objectionable, though not compromising, position. He killed her in a fit of rage even though he is as characterless as his daughter was."

GURDARSHAN SINGH, the then inspector general, Meerut zone, on the Aarushi murder case

HEMANT CHAWLA

"Raj Thackeray is a mental case. There should be strong action against Maharashtra Navnirman Sena. It should be banned."

LALU PRASAD YADAV
Union railways minister and RJD chief



HEMANT CHAWLA



"In India, when Olympics come we are not preparing for success, we are preparing for failure. It's a matter of attitude, of thinking, and that needs to change."

ABHINAV BINDRA
shooter and Olympic gold medallist

"I'm not a superstar and I'm not saying this for effect. I'm here to entertain people. I don't want to be No. 1 or No. 2. I just want to be alive and kicking in this industry."

AKSHAY KUMAR, actor

"Relations between India and Australia weren't damaged due to the incident (racism). The IPL came at the right time to ensure that ties were mended."

ADAM GILCHRIST
Australian cricketer

"A draconian (anti-terrorism) law is likely to be misused. We are known as one of the best protectors of human rights in the world."

K.G. BALAKRISHNAN, chief justice of India

"I have checked myself. His (Ajmal Kasab's) house has been cordoned off by security agencies. His parents are not allowed to meet anybody."

NAWAZ SHARIF, former Pakistan prime minister

"Those who say market growth is irrelevant and only helps the rich are enemies of the poor. They only want us to distribute poverty."

P. CHIDAMBARAM, former finance minister

